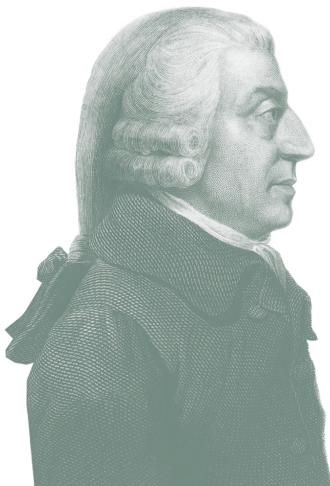


It's not fair!

Not all economists agreed with Smith. Many have pointed out situations where the market fails to work efficiently, benefitting only a few people (see [When markets don't DO THEIR JOB](#)). To prevent this, governments have to regulate the markets in some ways. Others, notably Karl Marx, argued that the market is inherently unfair and prone to ups and downs, with fluctuations of supply and demand, and that governments, not markets should decide on the allocation of resources.



ADAM SMITH (1723–90)

Born in Scotland, Adam Smith is widely regarded as the father of modern economics. He was a professor of philosophy at Glasgow University and one of a group of thinkers that included the philosopher David Hume. In the 1760s, Smith traveled to France and began work on *An Inquiry into the Nature and Causes of the Wealth of Nations*, which he finished in 1776.



In 2007, a portrait of Adam Smith was featured on the £20 banknote issued by the Bank of England.

See also: [The economic PROBLEM](#)